



Oracle Cloud Infrastructure – UK Public Sector Architects: FY26 Year in Review



Financial Year 2026



1. Foreword: why this year deserves recording

FY26 deserves more than a closing note because it was more than another operating year.

This is not intended to be a corporate bulletin. It is not a team yearbook either. It sits between the two: a reflection on what happened when Oracle's FY26 direction became field reality for the UK Public Sector OCI ACE team.

The year brought together many of the forces now shaping Oracle's future: AI moving into the centre of enterprise strategy, OCI gaining greater visibility in Oracle's growth story, sovereign cloud becoming more relevant to sensitive public sector conversations, multicloud becoming a more realistic customer choice, and One Oracle becoming an operating expectation rather than a useful phrase.

For this team, those themes did not arrive as neat strategy statements. They arrived through customer conversations, sector coverage, new go-to-market expectations, OCI and DBP collaboration, Q4 consumption focus, forecast scrutiny, workload hygiene, public sector assurance, maintenance communications, Edge strategy shifts, people changes, and the need to keep Oracle credible in complex customer environments.

That is why this reflection is worth writing down. FY26 was not only busy. Busy years can pass without changing much. FY26 changed how the team needed to think, prepare, qualify, explain, challenge, evidence and follow through.

The work was not always glamorous, but it was real. Some of it showed up in customer meetings, sector plans, Slack conversations, whitepapers, workshops, account reviews, forecast calls and qualification discussions. Some of it sat behind the scenes, in the quiet professional work of protecting relationships, clarifying messages, interpreting ambiguity and helping colleagues make better choices.

This document joins those threads together.

It begins with Oracle's broader FY26 context because the team's year should not be viewed in isolation. It then translates that context into the UK Public Sector environment, before turning to how the team experienced, absorbed and responded to it locally.

The point is not to pretend the year was neat. It was not.

The point is to recognise that the team did more than get through FY26. It built stronger habits, sharper judgement and a more deliberate way of working. That is the part worth carrying forward.

2. FY26 Strategic Signals

Several strategic signals shaped the environment around the team during FY26. None tells the whole story on its own. Together, they explain why the year felt so significant.

FY26 signal	Why it shaped the team's year
AI moved into the enterprise centre of gravity	Oracle's AI message became more closely tied to trusted data, applications, workflows, security, governance and measurable outcomes. For UK Public Sector, this shifted the conversation away from excitement and towards responsible deployment.
OCI gained greater strategic visibility	Oracle's public cloud and OCI narrative strengthened through reported cloud revenue growth, OCI revenue growth and significant RPO expansion. That gave the team a stronger platform story, while increasing the need for careful positioning.
Oracle's leadership structure shifted for the AI and cloud era	Clay Magouyrk and Mike Sicilia moving into CEO roles, with Safra Catz becoming Executive Vice Chair, gave visible weight to Oracle's infrastructure, applications, industries and AI growth model.
One Oracle became an operating expectation	Leadership messaging repeatedly emphasised applications, data, OCI, AI, industries, partners and people coming together around customer outcomes. For the team, this translated into the daily challenge of making Oracle feel coherent to customers.
UK sovereign cloud became more concrete	OCI Generative AI availability in UK Gov South, later security and control enhancements, and wider UK Sovereign Cloud service availability made sovereign AI and secure cloud conversations more specific.
UK government and defence relevance became more visible	Public announcements relating to UK government and defence, including the MoD agreement, gave stronger reference points for sensitive public sector discussions, while still requiring careful language around adoption and scope.
Public sector proof points improved, but remained selective	DWP Digital and other Oracle-published references were useful. They strengthened the evidence base but did not remove the need for precision.
Multicloud became more usable for UK customers	Oracle AI Database@AWS availability in London and Ireland strengthened the UK multicloud story for organisations already invested in AWS estates.
Execution pressure sharpened	Oracle's leadership messaging repeatedly moved from momentum to impact. Locally, that showed up through consumption focus, forecast scrutiny, Best Case discipline, SDD hygiene and qualification pressure.
AI changed how the team worked	The team's own AI journey moved from workshops and commentary into objection handling, evidence checking, customer storytelling, meeting preparation and the GPT Concierge direction.

These signals are the frame for the rest of this reflection.

The team's FY26 was not separate from Oracle's FY26. It was one local expression of it.

3. Oracle FY26: the wider story around us

Oracle's FY26 was shaped by a stronger and more visible story around AI, OCI, data, sovereign cloud, multicloud and customer-centred execution.

The AI narrative became more serious and more enterprise-focused. The strongest message was not AI as a general technology trend, or AI as a set of impressive demonstrations. It was AI where trusted enterprise data, business applications, workflows, security, governance and infrastructure meet.

That distinction is important. Customers were not only asking whether AI was interesting. They were asking whether it could be trusted, governed, secured, explained, integrated and measured. Oracle's most compelling FY26 AI positioning sat in that space: enterprise AI connected to the data and processes that already run critical organisations.

OCI also gained greater weight in Oracle's strategic identity. The cloud story was no longer only about infrastructure as a destination, or cloud migration as a technical exercise. OCI was increasingly positioned as a foundation for enterprise applications, AI, data platforms, multicloud architecture, sovereign requirements, performance-sensitive workloads and business-critical modernisation.

Oracle's reported financial indicators reinforced that direction. Across FY26 reporting available at the time this reflection was prepared, Oracle highlighted growth in cloud revenue, growth in OCI revenue and major expansion in remaining performance obligations. Those figures did not automatically translate into local customer adoption, but they strengthened Oracle's credibility as a cloud and AI infrastructure provider at a time when customers were assessing long-term platform choices.

Leadership changes added to that signal. The appointment of Clay Magouyrk and Mike Sicilia as CEOs, with Safra Catz moving to Executive Vice Chair, visibly aligned with Oracle's two major growth engines: cloud infrastructure and applications, connected through AI, data, industries and customer outcomes. The significance was not simply that roles changed. It was that Oracle's operating narrative became more clearly aligned to the AI and cloud era.

One Oracle was another defining theme. The strongest version of that message was practical, not decorative. Customers should feel the strength of the whole company, not the friction of its internal structures. Applications, data, OCI, AI, industries, partners, engineering, sales and customer success all needed to connect around customer outcomes.

For teams working in UK Public Sector, that had a direct implication. Public sector customers rarely buy because the market is excited. They buy when capability can be connected to mission, accountability, security, resilience, cost, procurement, citizen outcomes and public confidence. Oracle's cloud and AI narrative gave the team more to work with, but it also raised the standard for how carefully that narrative needed to be translated.

Sovereign cloud and multicloud became more usable during the year. UK Gov South Generative AI availability, further security and control developments, UK Sovereign Cloud service expansion, UK government and defence announcements, and Oracle AI Database@AWS in London and Ireland all gave the team more concrete material for customer conversations. These developments helped shift the discussion from general positioning towards more specific questions of architecture, assurance, residency, interoperability and workload fit.

The conclusion must remain precise. FY26 did not prove that Oracle had achieved broad UK Public Sector OCI adoption. It did not remove the need for careful qualification. It did not mean every customer concern had been answered.

A more credible conclusion is that Oracle's OCI, AI, sovereign and multicloud story became stronger, more current and more usable. The team had more relevant proof points, more visible momentum and more strategic material to draw on. That progress created opportunity, but also responsibility.

Momentum also came with scrutiny. Oracle's cloud and AI story gained visibility, while the wider market still tested the economics, timing and execution behind that growth. That balance is healthy to recognise. FY26 was not a simple victory narrative. It was a year of rising ambition, sharper expectation and greater pressure to convert energy into outcomes.

The same pattern appeared locally. The team had stronger material to use, but also more work to do in proving relevance, qualifying reality, protecting credibility and supporting customer confidence.

This was the Oracle year around us: more energy, more opportunity, more visibility and more expectation.

The task for the UK Public Sector OCI ACE team was not to repeat that story. The task was to make it usable in customer environments where precision counts.

4. What this meant for UK Public Sector OCI

The year gave UK Public Sector teams more to say, but also more responsibility for how carefully they said it.

Public sector customers do not respond well to loose claims, generic hype or messages detached from operating reality. Their questions are often harder, slower and more consequential. Where will the data sit? Who operates the service? What controls exist? How does this align to policy, assurance, procurement and resilience? How will risks be managed? What proof exists beyond the promise?

FY26 gave Oracle stronger answers in several areas, especially around sovereign cloud, secure modernisation, AI readiness and multicloud choice. Those answers did not remove every barrier, but they made the conversation more grounded.

Sovereign cloud became more tangible. OCI Generative AI availability in UK Gov South, private endpoint capability, broader UK Sovereign Cloud service availability, and public announcements relating to UK government and defence all strengthened the discussion. These were not abstract platform points. They connected directly to customer questions about residency, operational control, assurance, classification sensitivity, responsible AI and suitability for sensitive workloads.

The MoD agreement provided a meaningful UK defence reference point. DWP Digital gave a useful Oracle-published public sector reference around pensions modernisation. NHS SBS provided relevant adjacent Oracle Cloud evidence, particularly where applications and OCI-connected infrastructure sat together. Oracle AI Database@AWS in London and Ireland strengthened the multicloud story for customers whose operating reality already included AWS.

Each of those examples is useful. None should be inflated.

The strongest message is not that FY26 proved broad public sector OCI adoption. It is that the evidence base improved, the capability story became more concrete, and the team had stronger material to use in credible conversations.

That control is essential. A strong message becomes weaker when it runs ahead of the proof. Public sector credibility is often built through restraint: knowing what can be said confidently, what needs qualification, what should be positioned as emerging, and where the customer's own environment should shape the conversation.

AI was a good example. Oracle's AI message was strongest when grounded in trusted enterprise data, secure workflows, governance and measurable outcomes. For UK Public Sector, that framing was essential. AI conversations in government, healthcare, policing, defence, local government and education quickly become conversations about accountability, ethics, bias, resilience, explainability, data protection and public confidence.

Customers did not need AI enthusiasm from us. They needed help distinguishing what was real, what was ready, what was appropriate, what remained uncertain, and how Oracle's capabilities could be applied responsibly in their environment.

That made the ACE role more important. The work was not to amplify every message. It was to interpret, test and translate. It was to connect Oracle's direction to the customer's mission, while protecting the credibility of both the conversation and the relationship.

Multicloud also gained relevance. Many public sector organisations are not starting from a clean architectural slate. They have existing hyperscaler estates, contracts, skills, legacy systems, procurement decisions and operational dependencies. Oracle AI Database@AWS in London and Ireland gave the team a stronger way to discuss Oracle data value within that reality.

The significance was not that multicloud made every conversation easier. It gave Oracle a more credible route into customers who needed choice, interoperability and continuity rather than an all-or-nothing cloud decision.

Across all of this, the underlying test was customer confidence.

Sovereign cloud, AI, multicloud, database modernisation, Edge, maintenance communications, CSS assurance, procurement and workload resilience all connected to the same question: can Oracle show that it understands the seriousness of public sector environments and respond with accuracy, care and proof?

FY26 made that question more visible.

The Oracle story gave the team momentum. UK Public Sector required us to earn it conversation by conversation.

5. The GTM reality: two technology pillars, one customer experience

FY26 also asked the team to operate through a more nuanced Tech Cloud go-to-market model.

OCI and DBP / Data Platform had distinct roles. OCI carried the infrastructure, sovereign cloud, second-vendor, workload migration and GenAI platform lens. DBP / Data Platform carried the database, data modernisation, multicloud database and AI data strategy lens.

Those distinctions were useful internally. They helped clarify sales plays, ownership, specialist engagement and pursuit focus. The difficulty was ensuring that internal clarity did not become external confusion.

The customer should not have to assemble Oracle for themselves.

A customer does not need to decode whether a conversation belongs to OCI, DBP, Data Platform, AI Data Strategy, GenAI Platform, Core Infrastructure or Second Vendor. The customer needs Oracle to understand the problem, bring the right expertise, explain the value clearly, and make engagement easier rather than harder.

That was one of the real operating tests of FY26.

The team had to make judgement calls repeatedly. Was the customer conversation really about infrastructure, or was it about data modernisation? Was the AI opportunity a platform discussion, or was the customer still working through data readiness? Was multicloud the strategic frame, or simply the route to a specific database outcome? Should OCI lead, should DBP lead, or should Oracle show up as a joined team from the start?

Sales-play labels alone could not answer those questions. They required context, preparation and collaboration.

That is where One Oracle became practical. It was not a phrase to admire. It was a customer experience standard.

For UK Public Sector, this was especially significant because many customers already operate in complicated environments. They have mixed estates, historic contracts, layered governance, assurance obligations, procurement constraints, legacy dependencies and risk-sensitive decision paths. Oracle's internal model should help those customers, not add another layer of complexity.

The ACE role therefore became partly a translation role. Not only translating technology into business value, but translating Oracle into a coherent customer experience.

That showed up in collaboration with DBP colleagues. It showed up in the need for cleaner handovers. It showed up in sector narratives that connected Oracle capability to public sector mission. It showed up in Mark's work to create an OCI and DBP collaboration forum. It showed up in Katie's return from DBP to OCI, bringing practical awareness of both sides. It showed up in the repeated need to make Oracle's breadth feel joined-up rather than fragmented.

The lesson is straightforward.

The operating model is important, but the customer experience is more important. Where the internal model becomes more specialised, our responsibility is to become clearer.

For this team, that responsibility sat at the centre of FY26. The UK Public Sector OCI ACE role was never only to explain OCI. It was to help make Oracle usable, credible and coherent in some of the most demanding customer environments we serve.

6. The team's year: Oracle strategy lived locally

The UK Public Sector OCI ACE team did not experience FY26 as a clean sequence of strategy themes. The year arrived through operating-model change, customer conversations, sector coverage, internal handovers, forecast scrutiny, AI adoption, public sector assurance, and the daily work of making Oracle credible in demanding environments.

That is what makes the local story valuable. It shows what Oracle's FY26 direction looked like once it reached the field.

May to June: finding footing before certain.

FY26 began with movement before the year had fully settled.

New tools, process updates, WWB changes, Fast Start activity, compensation plans and support-access changes all signalled that this would not be a simple continuation of FY25. The team had to absorb immediate operating changes while also working out how the new year would reshape coverage, expectations and priorities.

The early leadership focus was deliberately grounding: name the immediate priorities, protect the work that creates value, and avoid letting uncertainty become an excuse for drift.

Oracle's wider signal was readiness and execution. Locally, the team was still finding its footing. The lesson was simple: clarity would need to be created before certainty arrived.

July to August: building fluency

The next phase moved from orientation to fluency.

AI learning accelerated through Meta, NVIDIA and broader GenAI enablement. Sovereign cloud and OC4 capability gave the team more relevant material for public sector conversations. Performance, trust, multicloud choice and enterprise cloud expectations became recurring threads in the team's reading and discussion. The collaboration guide with DBP colleagues also reflected a practical need to make Oracle's technology pillars work together in front of customers.

This was learning with a purpose. The team was being asked to raise the quality of its customer conversations.

Public sector customers were becoming more interested in AI, but also more demanding about how AI should be explained. Sovereignty was not a theoretical concept. Performance was not a generic claim. Multicloud was not just market positioning. Each topic needed to be accurate, defensible and relevant to the customer's own environment.

Oracle's AI, OCI and sovereign momentum gave the team more material. The local requirement was to turn that material into fluency.

September to October: turning energy into rhythm

September and October gave the year more structure.

The Q2 kick-offs created shared alignment. Monthly wins introduced a regular habit of recognising progress. Obstacle Breaker gave the team space to examine barriers. The weekly focus rhythm created a pattern across Strategy, Growth, Business and Wellness. One Horse Race, Player Swap and the Innovation Lab stretched strategic thinking, presentation confidence and the ability to connect Oracle capability to customer relevance.

This was also the period when Oracle's FY26 story became more visible. AI World, leadership change, cloud and AI momentum, and increased focus on pipeline validation all contributed to the sense that the team was operating during a year of consequence.

The response was rhythm.

Rhythm did not remove pressure, but it made the year more navigable. It gave the team shared language, repeated touchpoints and a way to connect strategic intent to weekly action.

Energy became more useful once it was organised.

November to December: turning intent into shared priorities

By November, the team's work had started to create more tangible shared priorities.

Sovereign Snapshots and the Blueprint Project were important because they showed the team building approaches that could outlast an individual meeting or account conversation. The halfway point of the fiscal year created space to pause, recognise progress and look towards H2 with greater intent. Best Case roles, Q3 momentum, sensible out-of-office discipline and year-end appreciation all reinforced the same point: professional standards show up in both strategic output and everyday habits.

This period was quieter than Q4 would become, but it was not passive. The team was moving from ideas into reusable assets, clearer operating practices and more deliberate preparation.

The shift was subtle but significant. FY26 was no longer something the team was reacting to. It was becoming something the team was learning how to shape.

January to March: proving strategy through execution

January changed the tempo.

The message moved from intent to action. Consumption focus sharpened. Diary discipline became more visible. Best Case syncs continued. SDD hygiene became a recurring concern. Workload qualification, OCVS BYOL, CSS assurance and war-room style activity brought the mechanics of FY26 closer to the surface.

This phase exposed an important truth: strategy only proves itself under operating pressure.

It is one thing to describe OCI momentum, sovereign cloud relevance, AI opportunity or One Oracle collaboration. It is another to convert those ideas into credible customer engagement, qualified workloads, accurate forecast inputs, documented solution intent and accountable follow-through.

CSS assurance was especially representative of the public sector reality. Service issues and operational incidents do not sit neatly away from the ACE role. They affect relationship confidence, account credibility and the customer's willingness to believe the next message.

The Q4 Finish Strong and FY27 Start Smart workshop began to bridge the current year with the next. Dan Westley's departure marked a human transition. Sector-led work, including policing strategy activity, showed that even under pressure, the team continued to build beyond immediate asks.

Aspiration had to meet the mechanics of delivery.

April to May: holding steady through the sharpest point

April and early May were the sharpest part of FY26.

Consumption outlooks, SE forecast reductions, missing SDDs, maintenance communications and Edge Infrastructure changes all arrived during a period when the team was already carrying significant load. This was not a gentle run-in to year-end. It was a test of composure.

At the same time, the AI in Practice series became one of the most significant developments of the final phase. AI moved from general interest into working methods: objection handling, evidence checking, better judgement, customer storytelling, meeting preparation and follow-through. The shift from individual tools towards a working GPT system showed how far the team's thinking had developed since the start of the year.

That contrast is worth holding onto. The hardest part of the year also produced some of the most applied capability-building.

Mark Jackson's resignation at the end of April added another transition point, particularly given the short handover period and the impact on Higher Education coverage. Katie stepping into additional Higher Education complexity after returning to OCI from DBP reflected the adaptability the year repeatedly required.

By early May, the tone of team communications had moved towards care, steadiness and holding together through change. That was not a retreat from performance. It was a recognition that performance under uncertainty requires more than urgency. It requires judgement, trust and the ability to remain useful when the environment is unsettled.

FY26 did not end by becoming easier. It ended by showing the value of steadiness.

7. What we built in response

The team's output in FY26 was not confined to accounts, meetings or opportunities. It was also visible in capability.

Several of the most useful things built during the year were not single artefacts. They were repeatable ways of working: rhythms, narratives, AI-supported methods, sector understanding and sharper commercial habits.

Operating rhythm

The weekly focus rhythm gave the team a way to organise attention across strategy, growth, business execution and wellbeing. Monthly wins created space to recognise progress before it disappeared into the next urgent ask. Obstacle Breaker created a forum for challenge and problem-solving. Q2 kick-offs, One Horse Race, Player Swap, Best Case roles and the Q4/FY27 workshop all added structure at different moments.

None of those mechanisms solved the year by themselves. Together, they created a more deliberate operating pattern.

That was useful because FY26 did not lack activity. It lacked natural calm. A team facing change, commercial scrutiny and shifting priorities needs rhythm so that every week does not become a fresh negotiation with the noise around it.

OCI narrative system

The team also built a stronger body of OCI narrative material.

Performance, sovereignty, enterprise cloud expectations, public sector procurement, UK policy landscape, economics, differentiation, misconceptions, industry-tailored Why OCI narratives, policing strategy, blueprinting and sector-specific thinking all formed part of a wider content system.

The point was not to produce more documents. The point was to improve the quality of the conversation

A good OCI narrative is not a louder OCI narrative. It is a clearer one. It understands which claims are strong, which require care, which need proof, and which will only land if connected to a customer's mission, constraint or risk.

That was especially important in UK Public Sector, where overstatement can weaken confidence quickly. FY26 pushed the team towards more careful language, better substantiation and stronger customer framing.

AI-enabled working methods

The team's AI journey became one of the distinctive threads of the year.

Early FY26 included workshops, learning opportunities, market commentary and the need to understand Oracle's enterprise AI story. By the final quarter, AI had become part of the team's working method: objection handling, evidence review, qualification, customer storytelling, meeting preparation and follow-through.

That progression is significant.

The value was not in using AI as a shortcut. The value was in using it to improve the thinking: to prepare more carefully, test assumptions, organise evidence, rehearse difficult messages, challenge weak claims and turn scattered information into usable insight.

The GPT Concierge direction was a natural extension of that journey. It reflected a move from individual tools towards a more organised system of support, where AI could help route questions, improve consistency and raise the quality of preparation.

The lesson for FY27 is straightforward: AI helps most when it strengthens human judgement.

Sector fluency

FY26 also deepened the team's sector understanding.

Defence, Defence Industry, Healthcare, Higher Education, Central Government, Law Enforcement, Public Safety, Home Office, Local Government, Scottish Government, NHS SBS and HES all carried different operating realities. Each brought its own pressures, decision paths, procurement considerations, relationship dynamics and confidence tests.

That breadth reinforced a point that should shape FY27: UK Public Sector is not one audience with one message.

Defence conversations are not Healthcare conversations. Policing and public safety require a different operating lens from Higher Education. Local Government and Scottish Government need their own context. Central Government brings different stakeholder and assurance dynamics. NHS SBS, HES, NHS England, FDP, Home Office, PDS, University of Manchester and others all sit within distinct patterns of trust, value and timing.

FY26 did not make each sector easy. It made clearer why each sector needs a deliberate approach.

Commercial clarity

Commercial discipline became a stronger part of the team's operating reality.

Consumption focus, Best Case coordination, pipeline validation, SDD hygiene, workload qualification, forecast reductions and account scrutiny all became more visible as the year progressed. Some of those conversations were uncomfortable. They forced a closer look at the difference between possibility, intent and reality.

That was healthy.

Better qualification, stronger documentation and clearer forecast integrity are not administrative burdens when handled properly. They help the team understand where effort should go, where risk sits, and where customer support is genuinely needed.

A poorly qualified opportunity wastes time. Weak proof creates distraction. Missing documentation can weaken continuity. Unclear ownership slows progress.

FY26 sharpened the connection between commercial clarity and customer care.

The deeper build

Taken together, these developments point to the deeper output of the year.

The team became more deliberate about how it prepared, qualified, explained, evidenced, collaborated and followed through.

That does not mean every operating challenge was solved. FY26 was too complex for that. It does mean the team leaves the year with more than experience.

It leaves with better habits.

8. What we carried

FY26 was demanding because several kinds of load arrived together.

The team worked through organisational movement, customer complexity, commercial scrutiny, shifting product narratives, evolving GTM expectations and the human reality of a year that rarely stood still. Some of that appeared in forecast calls. Some appeared in customer conversations. Some appeared through urgent asks, unresolved issues, changing guidance, handovers, or the need to stay calm when the wider environment was unsettled.

A proper review of the year should recognise both output and load. The year was not only about what the team produced. It was also about what the team absorbed.

Change

The team worked through significant organisational and personal movement.

The OCI and DBP operating model required clearer collaboration across technology pillars. Katie returned from a quarter spent as a DBP ACE into a role that was a stronger fit for her and for the business. Darren Goff joined partway through the year to strengthen Defence coverage while continuing his work with MoD. Mark Jackson resigned at the end of April, creating a short handover window and requiring others to steady Higher Education coverage. Dan Westley's departure was another visible marker of change. The wider RIF context shaped the emotional backdrop of the year, even where direct team headcount was protected.

Change of this kind is rarely just structural. It affects relationships, confidence, account continuity, workload balance and the informal support systems that teams rely on.

The team had to keep working through those shifts without allowing uncertainty to dominate the year.

Customer confidence

The team also held the relationship impact of difficult customer moments.

CSS assurance, maintenance communications, Edge Infrastructure changes and sensitive public sector conversations all required care. The team did not always own the root cause of issues, but it often had to face the relationship consequence. That is a difficult position, particularly in environments where confidence is hard won and easily damaged.

Public sector customers expect accuracy, timing, context and follow-through. They judge how Oracle behaves when the message is difficult, not only when the story is strong.

Sometimes the right response was to say less, but with more precision. Sometimes it was to keep a customer conversation warm while waiting for clearer guidance. Sometimes it was to help an account team understand the difference between reassurance and unsupported certainty.

That work is not always visible, but it influences customer confidence.

Commercial scrutiny

Commercial pressure increased as the year progressed.

Consumption outlooks, SE forecast reductions, workload hygiene, SDD completion, Best Case discipline, pipeline validation and account scrutiny all became more prominent. The work required sharper distinction between possibility, intent and reality.

Optimism can help, but only when connected to proof. Pipeline can encourage, but only when qualified. Consumption potential can be promising, but only when blockers, ownership, timing and customer readiness are understood.

FY26 asked the team to engage more directly with that level of rigour.

That was not separate from customer work. It was part of it. A team that understands its customers properly should also understand what is moving, what is stuck, what is at risk and where intervention is needed.

Human load

The year also had a human dimension.

There were heavy weeks, uncertainty, illness, leave, disruption, handover and fatigue. The team continued to operate through that while supporting customers, colleagues and Oracle.

That should not be over-dramatised, but neither should it be ignored.

Professional teams are not machines. People absorb pressure differently. Some hold it quietly. Some turn it into energy. Some respond by building. Some respond by helping others. Good leadership recognises that performance and humanity are connected.

FY26 asked a lot of the team. The response was not perfect, because no team's response to a year like this is perfect. But the team kept finding ways to remain useful, connected and professional.

That is part of why the year deserves to be recorded honestly.

9. The people who carried the mission

Different people carried different parts of FY26. That is not a weakness in the story. It is the story.

The examples below are not intended to compare contribution, scale or value. They are included to recognise how the team's strength came from sector ownership, customer confidence, technical judgement, resilience, collaboration and willingness to step into complexity.

Each person carried a distinct part of the mission.

Jackson Walmsley

Jackson carried Defence and Defence Industry from the start of FY26 and throughout the year. That placed him in one of the most strategically sensitive parts of the UK Public Sector landscape, directly connected to several of the year's harder themes: Edge, sovereign cloud, Defence credibility, senior stakeholder engagement and shifting product direction.

He put significant energy behind the core-to-edge story and helped create senior-level conversations that extended beyond one product narrative into a broader discussion about what OCI could offer Defence. As the Edge picture evolved, that work still created value because it strengthened Oracle's relevance and visibility in a sector where credibility is built over time.

Jackson's year should be recognised for sustained sector commitment through complexity, and for keeping the Defence conversation moving when the surrounding story was far from simple.

Darren Goff

Darren Goff joined the team just past the halfway point, strengthening Defence coverage while continuing his existing work with MoD. That timing was important. Defence already carried strategic weight, and the team needed additional experience and steadiness as FY26 moved into its more pressured phases.

Darren brought a grounded understanding of Defence customers and a practical approach to getting work done properly. His MoD experience gave the team continuity and confidence at a point when Oracle's UK government and defence story was becoming more visible externally.

Darren's contribution was felt in the stability, sector understanding and delivery discipline he brought into the team. He helped strengthen coverage where credibility cannot be improvised.

Mark Jackson

Mark led Higher Education for OCI through much of FY26. University of Manchester was the flagship account in that space, with a sale from a previous financial year moving into its adoption journey during this one. That made the work less about celebrating a closed win and more about supporting the harder phase of helping adoption progress in reality.

Mark also developed a collaboration forum spanning OCI and DBP. That contribution aligned directly to one of the year's central operating lessons: customers need Oracle to show up coherently across technology pillars. The forum was a practical response to that need and reflected the wider One Oracle direction of FY26.

Mark's resignation at the end of April created a short handover period and added pressure to the final stretch of the year. His departure should be acknowledged respectfully, without allowing it to dominate the wider team story.

His FY26 contribution sits in Higher Education ownership, University of Manchester continuity and the practical bridge he built across OCI and DBP.

Katie Armstrong

Katie re-joined the OCI team after a quarter spent as a DBP ACE. That return was right for Katie and right for the business. It brought her back into the part of the organisation where her strengths, interests and contribution could be used more naturally.

Katie retained Healthcare alignment while also taking on Central Government. Later in the year, following Mark's departure, she stepped forward to support Trinity College London and Open University, helping to steady Higher Education coverage at a difficult point.

That willingness to return, reset and then take on additional complexity says a great deal. FY26 repeatedly asked people to adapt without ideal conditions, and Katie did that with energy and ownership.

Katie's year should be recognised for adaptability, practical commitment and the willingness to step into areas where the team needed support.

Brendan Griffin

Brendan continued to own Law Enforcement, Public Safety and Home Office in FY26. He did so without an OCI Rep for much of the year, which made the role more demanding and increased the need for persistence, creativity and direct sector ownership.

He forged success in South Yorkshire Police and Humberside Police, while continuing to drive important relationships across Home Office, SSCL, Met Police and Police Digital Service. That mix of momentum and relationship-building is significant because policing and public safety are not easy markets to shift. They require patience, relevance, sector knowledge and sustained confidence.

Brendan's work also sat naturally alongside the year's wider emphasis on public sector credibility, sector-specific thinking and customer-centred narrative. His contribution showed what it looks like to keep building even when the surrounding coverage model is not ideal.

Brendan's year should be recognised for sector leadership, persistence and the energy he brought to Law Enforcement and Public Safety.

Darren Attack

Darren Attack took on Local Government across the UK as well as Scottish Government. Alongside that, he continued to support key account NHS SBS and maintained trust with HES as they continued their journey of exploration with Oracle and OCI.

That breadth required range. Local Government is not one uniform segment. Scottish Government brings its own context. NHS SBS carries strategic relevance and complexity. HES required a careful,

trust-led approach rather than overstatement. Darren's strength throughout FY26 was the ability to remain steady, thoughtful and grounded across varied customer environments.

He also continued to be an important source of security knowledge and practical customer judgement for the team. That kind of contribution is not always captured in formal milestones, but it affects the quality of many conversations around him.

Darren's year should be recognised for breadth, steadiness, security judgement and the credibility he brought to complex relationships.

Stefan Slatter

Stef carried the largest share of Healthcare nationally. His key accounts included NHS Blood and Transplant and NHS England, with the FDP programme linking him to Palantir as a high-value target for consumption.

That portfolio brought scale, sensitivity and complexity. Healthcare customers require patience, credibility and a strong understanding of both technology and organisational context. The FDP and Palantir dimension added another layer because the opportunity was potentially significant, but not straightforward. It required persistence, careful relationship-building and disciplined handling of customer appetite, timing and readiness.

Stef's FY26 story should not be reduced to one account or one programme, even where those programmes carried high visibility. His broader contribution was the consistent effort to keep OCI relevant and credible across a nationally significant Healthcare landscape.

Stef's year should be recognised for patience, persistence and the credibility he maintained across one of the team's most complex sector portfolios.

The value of the combination

No single person carried FY26 alone.

Jackson and Darren Goff carried Defence and Defence Industry through a strategically important and shifting year. Stef carried a major Healthcare portfolio. Brendan carried Law Enforcement, Public Safety and Home Office with limited local sales coverage for much of the year. Darren Attack carried Local Government, Scottish Government, NHS SBS and HES with steadiness and breadth. Katie returned to OCI, retained Healthcare, took on Central Government and stepped into Higher Education complexity. Mark led Higher Education and built a practical bridge across OCI and DBP before leaving the team.

Taken together, that is the point.

The team's value was not found in one account, one sector, one initiative or one individual. It was found in how different people held different parts of a complicated year and still formed a coherent team around customers, colleagues and Oracle's public sector mission.

10. What FY26 taught us

FY26 did not teach one lesson. It sharpened a way of working.

The value of the year was not only in the accounts supported, material created, opportunities progressed, or meetings held. Its deeper value was in the judgement developed through pressure.

Five lessons stand out.

Strategy has to become useful

Oracle's FY26 strategy was significant: AI, OCI, sovereign cloud, multicloud, Data Platform, One Oracle and customer-centred execution. Yet no customer needs us simply to repeat Oracle's strategy back to them.

A customer needs us to make it relevant.

That means understanding their operating environment, constraints, procurement path, data posture, risk appetite, technical dependencies and mission. The ACE role sits in that translation layer. It turns platform direction into credible options. It turns internal strategy into customer meaning. It turns broad momentum into practical next steps.

The strongest technical leaders are not the ones who can recite the most content. They are the ones who can make the right content useful at the right moment.

One Oracle has to be experienced by the customer

One Oracle was one of the defining leadership themes of FY26, but its real test was practical.

Customers do not experience One Oracle because we describe it. They experience it when Oracle brings the right people together, removes confusion, clarifies ownership and makes engagement easier.

That was why OCI and DBP collaboration became such an important thread. The distinction between OCI and Data Platform had real internal purpose, but customers should not have to decode Oracle's organisation before they can understand Oracle's value.

Where an opportunity crosses infrastructure, database, AI data strategy, multicloud, GenAI platform, applications or partner considerations, the answer cannot be internal complexity. The answer has to be a clearer customer experience.

Collaboration only has value when it improves the outcome.

AI should strengthen judgement

The team's AI journey was one of the clearest examples of progress during the year.

At the start of FY26, AI was something to learn about, discuss and explain. By the end of the year, it had become something to use with more discipline: to prepare, challenge, summarise, research, test, evidence, rehearse and improve the quality of work.

That is the right direction.

AI should not replace judgement. It should raise the standard of judgement. It should make preparation stronger, not lazier. It should expose weak claims, not decorate them. It should help people think more clearly, not simply produce more words.

The advantage is not in using AI the most. The advantage is in using it with the most care.

Trust is built through behaviour, not claims

Public sector confidence is not created by confident statements. It is built through accuracy, consistency, restraint and follow-through.

That lesson appeared repeatedly during the year: in sovereignty conversations, AI discussions, procurement thinking, CSS assurance, maintenance communications, Edge shifts, workload qualification and customer-facing narrative. The team often had to judge not only what could be said, but how it should be said, when it should be said, and what proof should sit behind it.

That kind of judgement does not always produce a visible artefact, but it directly influences customer confidence.

Credibility is not only technical. It is behavioural. Customers notice whether Oracle is careful with language, honest about uncertainty, serious about their environment and willing to follow through after the meeting.

Discipline and care belong together

Commercial discipline can sound cold if it is separated from the customer. FY26 showed why it should not be.

Best Case discipline, SDD completion, workload hygiene, consumption focus, forecast scrutiny and account-level clarity all support a more honest understanding of where effort should go. They help avoid wishful thinking. They force better qualification. They expose gaps early. They create a clearer view of what is real, what is at risk and what needs support.

That helps Oracle. It also helps customers.

A poorly qualified opportunity wastes customer time. A weakly evidenced forecast creates internal distraction. Missing documentation weakens continuity. Unclear ownership slows progress.

Discipline, handled properly, is not the opposite of care. It is one of the ways care becomes operational.

11. What we carry into FY27

FY27 will bring its own structure, priorities and unknowns. The point of reflecting on FY26 is not to preserve the year behind us. It is to decide what deserves to come forward.

The team should not enter FY27 empty-handed. FY26 gave us sharper habits, clearer lessons and stronger instincts.

Evidence-led confidence

Confidence will remain important in FY27, but it should be anchored in proof.

Oracle's OCI story is stronger than it was. The AI story is more credible. The sovereign cloud discussion is more concrete. Multicloud gives customers more options. The wider Oracle narrative has more energy and more visibility.

Even so, confidence should not become overstatement.

The best version of our message will continue to be precise: clear about what Oracle can evidence, honest about what still needs qualification, and disciplined about the difference between capability, customer interest, adoption and delivered outcome.

That kind of confidence earns its place.

AI as a disciplined working habit

AI should continue to become part of how the team works, with human judgement at the centre.

The strongest use of AI will not be to produce more content faster. It will be to improve preparation, test logic, strengthen evidence, draft better questions, rehearse difficult conversations, summarise complex input, challenge assumptions and make follow-through more consistent.

The GPT Concierge direction belongs in that category. The goal is not novelty. The goal is a more reliable working system that helps people find the right support, use the right prompts, ask better questions and improve the quality of customer-facing work.

FY27 should carry forward a simple principle: AI is most valuable when it helps us become more thoughtful, not merely more productive.

Sharper sector plays

The sector breadth of FY26 gives the team a stronger foundation for FY27.

Defence, Defence Industry, Healthcare, Higher Education, Central Government, Law Enforcement, Public Safety, Home Office, Local Government, Scottish Government, NHS SBS and HES all taught different lessons. Those lessons should not remain isolated in individual account knowledge. They should strengthen how the team thinks about the UK Public Sector market as a whole.

Sector focus should become more deliberate:

- clearer understanding of customer missions;
- stronger awareness of buying paths;

- better sector-specific language;
- more thoughtful use of examples;
- more disciplined qualification;
- more reusable narratives.

UK Public Sector is not a single audience. FY26 made that impossible to ignore.

Cleaner OCI and DBP collaboration

FY27 should continue the work of making OCI and DBP collaboration clearer and more useful.

The customer should not feel internal handoffs, unclear ownership or competing narratives. They should experience one Oracle team that understands the problem and brings the right expertise at the right time.

That will require practical behaviours:

- clearer qualification at the start;
- better agreement on lead motion;
- cleaner handover where needed;
- shared preparation before customer meetings;
- less duplication;
- stronger alignment around customer outcomes.

The lesson from FY26 is not that collaboration is easy. The lesson is that it is essential when the customer problem spans data, infrastructure, AI, applications and cloud operating models.

Public sector trust as a standard

Public sector confidence should remain one of the team's defining standards in FY27.

That means careful language. It means proof. It means understanding assurance concerns. It means being thoughtful about sovereignty, procurement, security, service communications and operational risk. It means knowing when to challenge and when to listen. It means protecting credibility even when the message is difficult.

Public sector customers are not only assessing Oracle's technology. They are assessing whether Oracle behaves like a partner that understands responsibility.

That standard should come forward deliberately.

Rigour without losing care

FY26 showed the importance of commercial rigour. FY27 will need more of it, not less.

Forecast quality, workload hygiene, SDD completion, account clarity, qualification and consumption focus will continue to be important. The team should treat those disciplines as part of how we protect focus and improve execution.

The year also showed that rigour works best when held together with care.

People do not do their best work when everything becomes pressure. They do their best work when expectations are clear, purpose is understood, support is available, and the team remains connected enough to be honest with one another.

That balance should come forward into FY27: pace without losing judgement, ambition without losing perspective, rigour without losing humanity.

A fresh page, not a blank one

FY27 should be treated as a fresh page, but not a blank one.

A blank page ignores what was learned. A fresh page respects it.

The team can begin FY27 with the benefit of what FY26 revealed: stronger habits, clearer sector understanding, better AI practice, sharper evidence discipline, more explicit collaboration needs and a deeper appreciation of how public sector confidence is built.

That is the carry-forward.

Not a claim that everything is solved. A recognition that the team is better prepared because of what it has lived through.

12. Closing reflection

FY26 was bigger than a collection of meetings, emails, workshops, account reviews and forecast calls.

It was Oracle's strategy becoming real in the field. AI became more than a topic. OCI became more central to the company's story. Sovereign cloud became more concrete. Multicloud became more usable. One Oracle became a customer experience standard, not simply a leadership phrase. Commercial scrutiny sharpened. Public sector confidence became an even clearer test of how Oracle shows up.

The UK Public Sector OCI ACE team lived that year locally.

The team navigated transition, changing coverage, customer complexity, Edge uncertainty, maintenance communications, consumption focus, forecast scrutiny, workload hygiene, sector demands, internal collaboration, people changes and the constant need to remain credible in front of customers.

It also built.

It built rhythm. It built stronger narratives. It built sector fluency. It built AI-supported working habits. It built better ways to qualify, evidence, prepare and follow through. It built stronger connections between Oracle's wider direction and the public sector conversations where that direction had to become useful.

The point is not to pretend the year was neat. It was not.

Not every pressure was resolved. Not every handover was smooth. Not every opportunity moved as hoped. No honest reflection would claim otherwise.

Yet the year leaves behind something valuable.

It leaves behind a team that understands more clearly what it holds. A team that has seen the difference between momentum and execution. A team that has learned that AI needs judgement, public sector confidence needs proof, collaboration needs structure, and resilience is built through repeated behaviours.

We were not observers of Oracle's FY26.

We were one of the teams asked to make it real in customer conversations where accuracy, assurance and execution count.

Yes, we really did go through all of that.

And we did it together.

That deserves recognition.

It also deserves to be carried forward.

Appendix: A note on method

This reflection draws together FY26 team communications, Oracle public announcements, senior leadership themes, corporate bulletin messages, Tech Cloud go-to-market context, sector coverage and contribution notes.

It is also an example of the approach discussed throughout the year: human-led, AI-assisted and judgement-protected.

The value was not in using AI to replace perspective. The value was in using AI to organise evidence, connect themes, test wording risk, identify repetition, preserve nuance and turn a complex year into something the team can understand and carry forward.

The output still depends on human judgement: what to include, what to soften, what to omit, what not to overclaim, and how to make the final message feel honest, useful and worthy of the year it reflects.